



Cougar

The Canadian-built Cougar Fire Support Vehicle is a light, wheeled vehicle that can trace its lineage back to the 1970s' Swiss-built Mowag Piranha—a multirole family of vehicles that had 4x4, 6x6, 8x8, and 10x10 wheel configurations. Cheaper to build and easier to transport than a tracked vehicle, the Cougar is also less aggressive looking, making it ideal for peacekeeping and peace-enforcement roles.

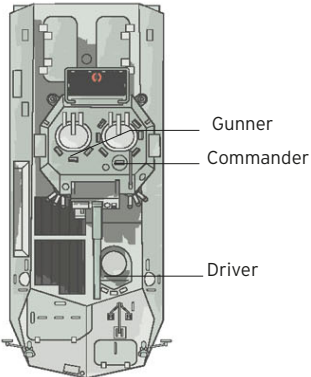
THE COUGAR was ordered for the Canadian Armed Forces in 1977 as part of a family of three Armored Vehicle General Purpose (AVGP) fighting vehicles—the other two being the Grizzly armored personnel carrier, and the Husky wheeled maintenance and recovery vehicle. Rather than being built from scratch, it was developed from the proven design of the Mowag Piranha I, which first saw service in 1974. The Cougar was intended to equip armored units that were not issued with Leopard tanks (see pp.150–53), and it was used in Canada for training in a reconnaissance and later a fire support role. The vehicle had the basic 6x6 hull, with the driver at the front, next to the Detroit Diesel engine, and two more crew members, the commander and the gunner, in the turret. It was equipped with the British Scorpion light tank turret (see pp.192–95), complete with a 76 mm gun, a coaxial machine gun, and eight smoke launchers. Ten rounds for the main gun were carried in the turret and another 30 rounds were stored in the hull. The rear compartment also had room for two more troops.

The Cougar saw peacekeeping service in Bosnia with IFOR—or the Implementation Force that was sent to ensure peace in the region after the signing of the Dayton Peace Accords in 1995. The vehicle has now been withdrawn from service, along with the other two AVGP vehicles.



REAR VIEW



SPECIFICATIONS		
Name	Cougar AVGP	
Date	1976	
Origin	Canada	
Production	496	
Engine	Detroit Diesel 6V53T 2-cycle turbocharged, 275 hp	
Weight	11.80 tons (10.70 tonnes)	
Main armament	76 mm L2A1	
Secondary armament	7.62 mm C6 machine gun	
Crew	3	
Armor thickness	0.4 in (10 mm)	